

ASSESSMENT BRIEF

Module title	Postgraduate Study and Research Methods
Module code	COM742
Module leader	Julie Mayers
Assessment title	Assignment 1 Part 1 Research Overview
Submission deadline	22 December 2025
Expected date for return of marks and feedback	Grades and feedback will be available on Moodle under the 'Assessment and Feedback' section. This will be made available within 15 working days and consist of annotations on the submission.
Module outcomes assessed	1. Display a mastery of communicating computing and IT related information
Assessment weighting	10%
Word count	300 words (+/- 10%)

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Assessment task details

You will work on this assignment individually and submit your own work as a single file to Moodle . Submit your abstract only (see below); there's no need to submit the original article as well.

You will be issued with an academic paper to use for this assignment (see COM742 on Moodle):

- Paper with no abstract – Ne'er the Twain Shall Meet?

Your task is to supply a 300-word (+/- 10%) abstract summarising the paper, including the case it attempts to make and how it achieves this. Your abstract should include the paper's purpose and structure and touch upon its methods of explanation.

Guidance and submission instructions

You are advised to read the paper at least twice (skim and detail) before you attempt to write the abstract. You will probably want to refer to parts of the paper for detail a third time as you draft the abstract.

On submission, a Turnitin check will be performed automatically and unusually high levels of similarity will be flagged to the marker. By submitting this work, you confirm that you have read, understand and accept the university's regulations regarding plagiarism and agree to be dealt with accordingly if any such situation should arise.

Work should be submitted as a single Word or PDF document only. This abstract should be written using the correct grammar; it must be formatted appropriately and submitted online via the appropriate Turnitin submission link found on the module space.

You will work on this assignment individually. In working individually, you must not share your ideas, data or other work product with other students.

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Hints and tips
All learning material will be found on the VLE Moodle Page. All submitted work is expected to observe academic standards in terms of referencing, academic writing, use of language etc. Failure to adhere to these instructions may result in your work being awarded a lower grade than it would otherwise deserve.
Marking and moderation
All grades/marks are indicative and may change when moderated – see the last page for the marking criteria.
Penalties for late submission
Work submitted up to a week late without a valid reason can only gain a maximum of 40%. If an extension is required, then an Request for Extension to Assignment Deadline Form must be completed and agreed prior to the submission date. Any work submitted more than a week late without a valid reason may be read but will not be marked.
Support arrangements
Support will be provided via Moodle, lectures, and MS Teams. If students have any special requirements, they are advised to inform the lecturer. For additional support see the Learning Skills department. Here you can access the Academic Skills Tutors, Digital Learning Facilitators, and Academic Support Librarians.

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Employability Skills Applied	
On successful completion of this module, a student will have had opportunities to demonstrate achievement of the following Employability Skills: Tick all that apply.	
CORE ATTRIBUTES	
Engaged	✓
Creative	✓
Enterprising	
Ethical	
KEY ATTITUDES	
Commitment	
Curiosity	✓
Resilient	✓
Confidence	✓
Adaptability	✓
PRACTICAL SKILLSETS	
Digital fluency	✓
Organisation	✓
Leadership and team working	
Critical thinking	✓
Emotional intelligence	✓
Communication	✓

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Marking Criteria						
ELEMENT	ASSESSMENT TASK	<40:	40%+:	50%+:	60%+:	70%+:
Covering and explaining the concept	General discussion of the structure and purpose of the paper and the case it makes	Insufficient general discussion or confused purpose	Reasonable general discussion of purpose	Good general discussion of purpose	Very good general discussion of purpose	Publication-ready general discussion of purpose
Relating different parts and examples	Referring briefly to examples and the evidence they contribute	Insufficient specific discussion or confused focus	Reasonable specific discussion and focus	Good specific discussion and focus	Very good specific discussion and focus	Publication-ready specific discussion and focus